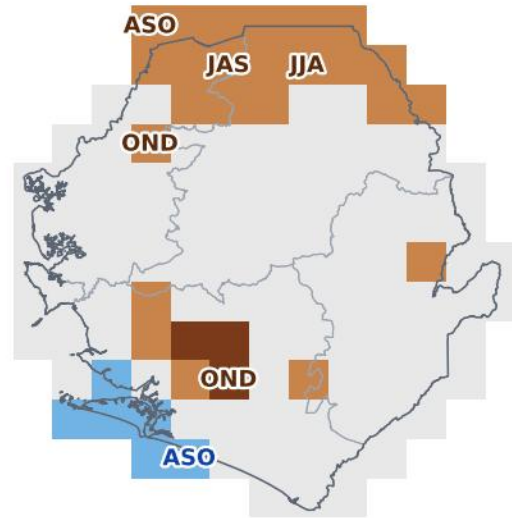


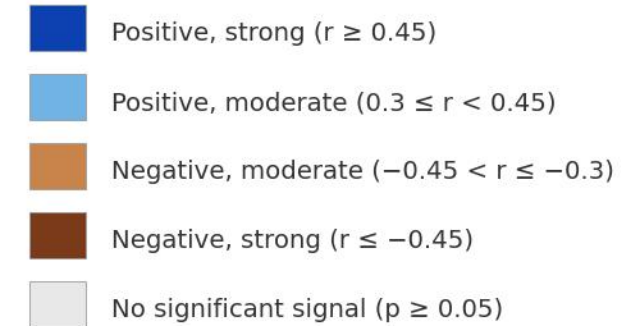
Sierra Leone: how does El Niño generally affect seasonal rainfall?

Pixelwise partial correlation of rainfall with Niño3.4 (ENSO), other climate modes held constant — ERA5 0.25° grid, 1981–2025

Unique ENSO signal — strongest significant trimester per pixel



Partial correlation with Niño3.4



Brown = El Niño years tend to be drier than normal in that season; blue = wetter.

Method (the teleconnections page's partial pass):

- Trimester rainfall means per pixel, all 12 overlapping 3-month windows, 1981–2025
- Partial r of rainfall vs Niño3.4, holding DMI (IOD), TNA, TSA and AMM constant
- Each mode at its per-pixel best lag (0–3 mo)
- Two-tailed $p < 0.05$, df adjusted for controls
- All seasons kept (no rainy-season filter)

JFM



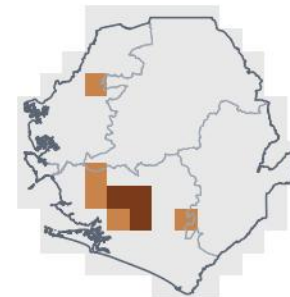
AMJ



JAS



OND

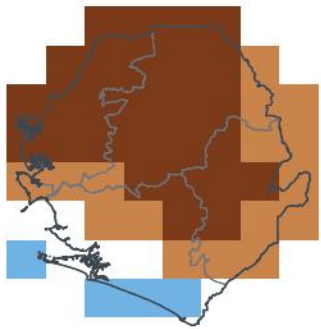


Data: ERA5 monthly precip (0.25°), NOAA PSL Niño3.4. Bottom row: the four quarters of the year.

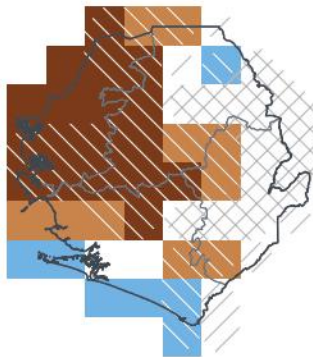
Sierra Leone: what seasonal rainfall is predicted this year (August-issued forecast)?

SEAS5 (issued August 2026) accounts for El Niño and every other driver · return-period categories vs the 1981–2025 hindcast · skill-shaded · ADM1

JJA 2026 — in season
1-in-15 dry · 4th pct



JAS 2026 — in season
1-in-8 dry · 11th pct



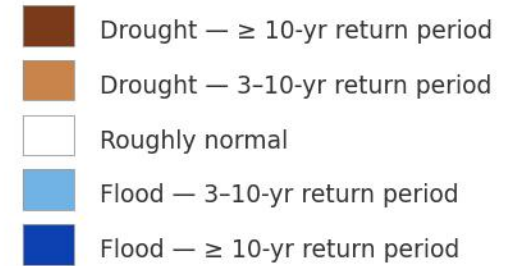
ASO 2026 — in season
1-in-2 wet · 56th pct



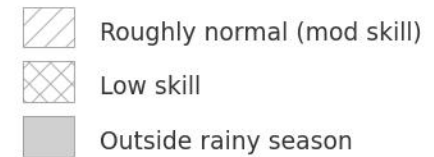
SON 2026 — lead 1 mo
1-in-3 wet · 64th pct



Forecast (high skill):



Other:



OND 2026 — lead 2 mo
1-in-9 wet · 91st pct



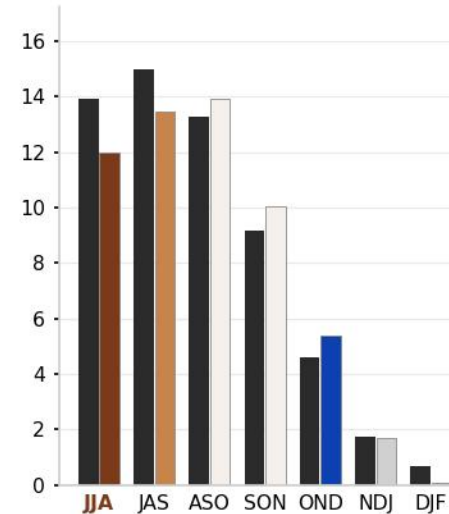
NDJ 2026/27 — lead 3 mo
off-season



DJF 2026/27 — lead 4 mo
off-season



Country-mean rainfall (mm/day)
black = normal · coloured = forecast



White hatch on a colour = moderate skill.
Tile subtitles: the country-level return period and percentile from the alerts app.
Driest outlook: JJA 2026 (1-in-15 dry).
In season = observed months + forecast.
Niño3.4: +1.7 °C in Jul 2026.